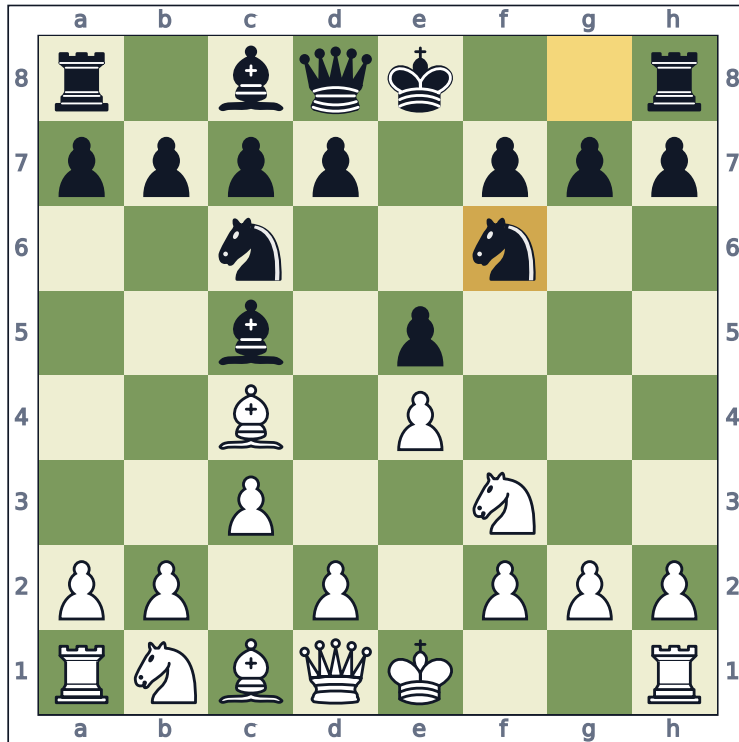


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C54 | 46 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.32 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C54 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game: Classical Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c3, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Italian Game: Classical Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6

002 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Center Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4

003 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Ghulam-Kassim Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 Ne4 7. Bd5 Nxf2 8. Kxf2 dxc3+ 9. Kg3

004 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3

005 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6

006 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3

007 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 h6 6. c3

008 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. c3 d5

009 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 Bb6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 O-O

011 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a5

012 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6

013 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6 7. Re1

014 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6 7. a4

015 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 h6 7. Nbd2

016 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 h6 7. Re1

017 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 O-O 7. O-O

018 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6 7. Re1 Ba7

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6 7. a4 Ba7

020 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 a6 7. a4 O-O

021 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, Albin Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. b4

022 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, Main Line**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. O-O O-O 7. Re1 a6 8. Bb3 Ba7 9. h3

023 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, with a4 a5**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. O-O O-O 7. a4 a5

024 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, with a5**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 a5 6. c3

025 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, with a6**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 a6

026 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, with a6**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 a6

027 **Italian Game: Classical Variation, Giuoco Pianissimo, with h6**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 d6 6. c3 h6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

028 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Anderssen Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 d5 7. Bb5 Ne4 8. cxd4 Bb4+

029 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Dubov Italian
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. b4

030 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Greco Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Nxc3

031 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Main Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Bxc3

032 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Modern Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5

033 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Modern Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 d5

034 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Moeller-Bayonet Attack
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Bxc3 9. d5 Bf6 10. Re1 Ne7 11. Rxe4 d6 12. g4

035 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Moeller-Therkatz Attack
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Bxc3 9. d5

036 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Greco Gambit, Traditional Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

037 Italian Game: Classical Variation, with d5

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d3 d5

038 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Aitken Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Nxc3 9. bxc3 Bxc3 10. Ba3

039 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Bernstein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Nxc3 9. bxc3 Bxc3 10. Qb3 d5

040 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Cracow Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Kf1

041 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Greco's Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3

042 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Holzhausen Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. O-O Bc5 5. d4 Bxd4 6. Nxd4 Nxd4 7. Bg5 d6 8. f4 Qe7 9. fxe5 dxe5 10. Nc3

043 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Krause Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Bd2 Nxe4 8. Bxb4 Nxb4 9. Bxf7+ Kxf7 10. Qb3+ d5 11. Ne5+ Kf6 12. f3

044 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Rosentreter Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. O-O Bc5 5. d4 Bxd4 6. Nxd4 Nxd4 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4 g5 9. f4

045 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Bxc3 9. bxc3 d5 10. Ba3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C54 line

This section preserves all 46 names and defining routes assigned to C54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

046 Italian Game: Giuoco Piano, Therkatz-Herzog Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Nc3 Nxe4 8. O-O Bxc3 9. d5 Bf6 10. Re1 Ne7 11. Rxe4 d6 12. Bg5 Bxg5 13. Nxg5 O-O 14. Nxh7